

predictions

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structure

- introduction
- historical predictions
- prediction activity 1
- prediction activity 2
- wrap-up



prediction

/pri'dikshən/

- a statement about a future event or data
- often formed using the modal verbs:
 - **will, shall, or would** – when the speaker is sure about the event happening
 - **might or may** – when the speaker has some basis to believe the event is possible to happen
 - **won't** – when the speaker doesn't believe the event will happen

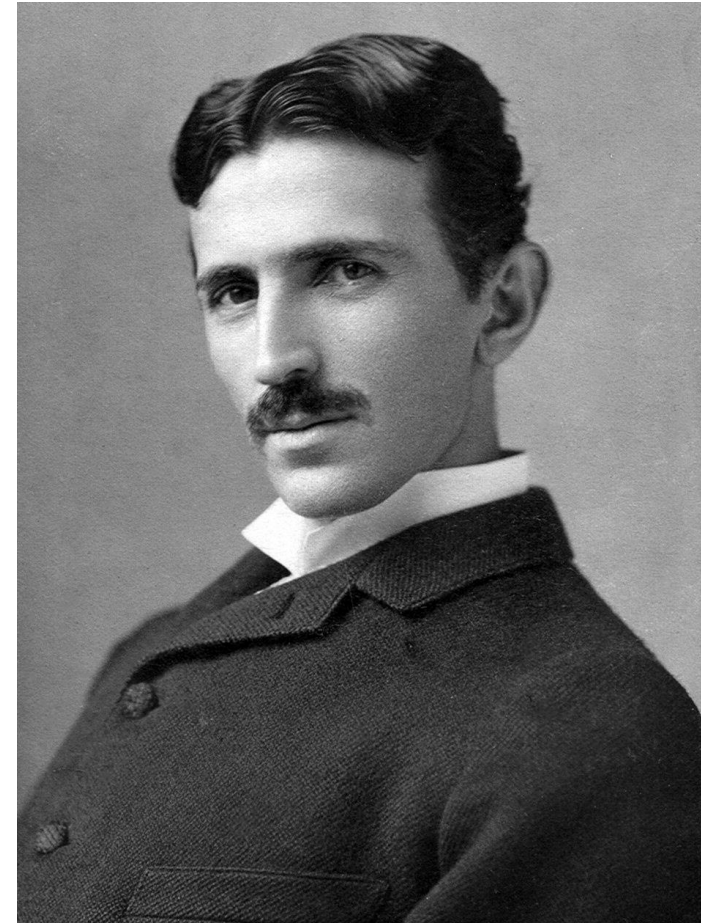


**famous historical
predictions**

Nikola Tesla predicts the smartphone

1926

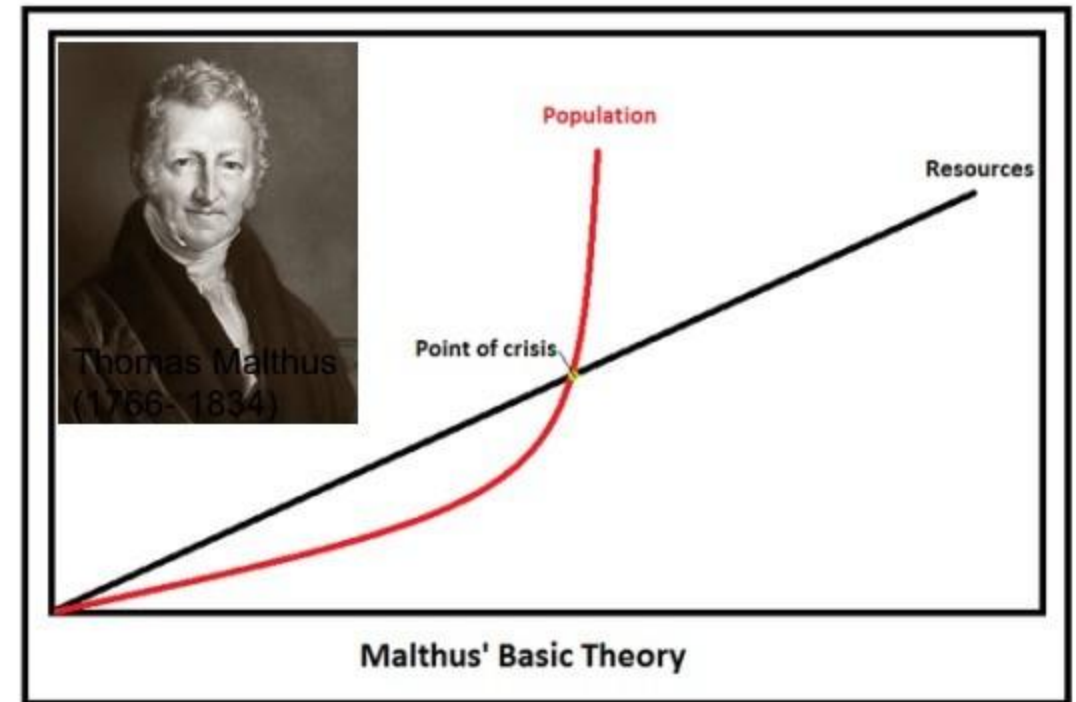
- *"When wireless is perfectly applied the whole earth will be converted into a huge brain..."*
- *We shall be able to communicate with one another instantly, irrespective of distance.*
- *We shall see and hear one another as perfectly as though we were face to face...*
- *and the instruments through which we shall be able to do his will be amazingly simple...*
- *A man will be able to carry one in his vest pocket."*



Thomas Malthus's population catastrophe

1798

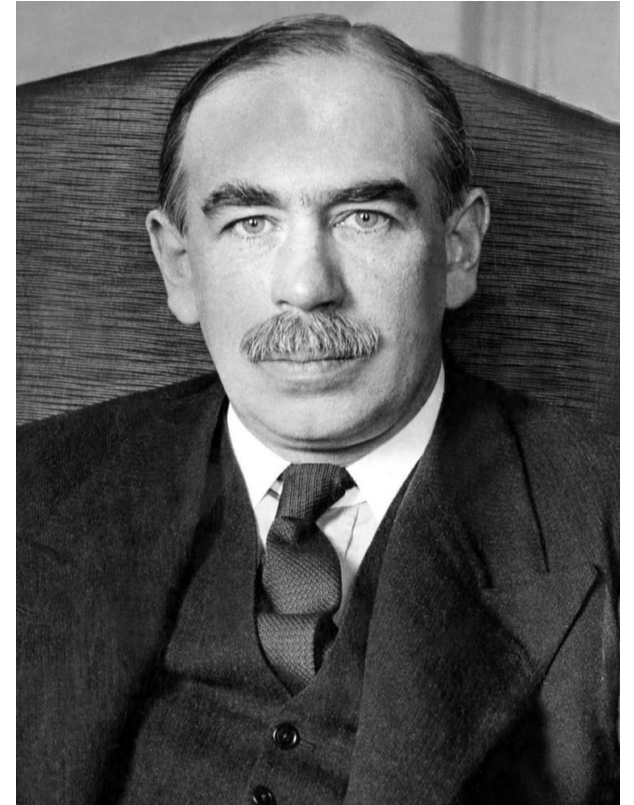
- English economist Thomas Malthus predicted that human population would inevitably outgrow the food supply, leading to mass starvation
- he noted that populations grow exponentially, while agricultural output grows linearly
- but he didn't account for synthetic fertilizers



Keynes' 15-hour work week

1930

- John Maynard Keynes predicted that by the year 2030, technology would be so efficient that we would only have to work 15 hours a week.
- we would spend the rest of our time enjoying our hobbies and relaxing.
- came true partially



activity time!

split into teams, take notepads

**in year 2036, instead of going
to the cinema, people are
asking AI to generate films to
their tastes**

will / might / won't happen?

**in year 2056, in Europe, clean
water access is restricted to
only a certain amount of litres a
week for each person**

will / might / won't happen?

**in year 2226, humans have
evolved to possess traits very
different from the humans of
today**

will / might / won't happen?

second activity time!

stay in the same teams, keep your notepads

**write down a prediction that
you think *will* be true for year
2126**

**write down a prediction that
you think *won't* be true for year
2026**

**write down a prediction that
you think *may* be true for year
2046**

wrap-up

feedback, review

- do you feel your prediction abilities improve?
- can you foresee the future now?
- what are the biases affecting our predictions?



sources

- <https://en.wikipedia.org>
- <https://www.merriam-webster.com>

**thank you for your
attention !!**